[METRIC]

A-A-2866
February 1, 1994

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

EASEL, DISPLAY AND TRAINING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

1. SCOPE: This commercial item description covers folding easels which can function as a chalkboard, dry erase markers board, display board, or be used for visual presentation. The easel shall be of the following types, as specified.

Type I - Green chalk board easel
Type II - White melamine board, dry erase markers easel

2. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

A. Design. Unless otherwise specified, the easel shall be of the following design:

1. Type I. The easel shall contain a panel having a front working surface of green chalkboard; two posts to provide a means for holding paper; legs which fold or telescope compactly for storage; bracing leg(s) which, when opened, shall swing or pivot out to maintain the easel in an upright position, and shall be held in place by a spring-type release pin and slot, or comparable type positive locking mechanism. A pin or locking mechanism (including bolts/wing nuts, clips, etc.) shall provide reliable protection against accidental collapse of the easel during use or relocation within a work area. A handle for carrying of the folded easel, shall be securely attached at a suitable location.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document, should be sent to: General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, 26 Federal Plaza, New York N.Y. 10278 ATTN: Engineering Branch (2FYEE).

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 7520

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2. Type II. The easel shall contain a panel having a front working surface of white melamine board; legs which fold or telescope compactly for storage; bracing leg(s) which, when opened, shall swing or pivot out to maintain the easel in an upright position, and shall be held in place by a spring-type release pin and slot, or comparable type positive locking mechanism. A pin or locking mechanism (including bolts/wing nuts, clips, etc.), shall be capable of being released without the aid of tools, and shall provide reliable protection against accidental collapse of the easel during use or relocation within a work area. A handle for carrying of the folded easel, shall be securely attached at the suitable location.

B. Construction. The easel shall be constructed so that all parts are aligned in accordance with normal commercial practice, and shall not become loose during the normal use of the easel. Maximum rigidity and stability of the overall structure shall be readily demonstrated by the performance test (see 3.D).

1. Panel. The panel shall be made of tempered hardboard, aluminum, steel, or other commercially acceptable suitable metal (see 2.D.1.) at the manufacturer's option. The front chalkboard surface shall be such that chalk will produce distinct and uniform markings which can be erased with a felt eraser. The dimensions of the working surface of the panel shall be not less than 69.9 cm (27-1/2") wide by 91.4 cm (36") high. Hardboard panel edges shall finished with a frame. Aluminum or steel panels shall be enclosed in either a frame or shall be turned or rounded in such a manner as to impart strength and rigidity.

2. Posts or Projections. The top of the working surface of the panel shall have two posts or other projections which shall satisfactorily accommodate paper pads up to 12.7 mm (1/2") in thickness. The posts or projections shall be not less than 5.56 mm (7/32") in diameter and located at equal distances from the panel sides. Posts or projections shall accommodate paper pads with two holes. The diameter of holes shall be 7.94 ± 1.59 mm (5/16 ± 1/16 "). The distance between holes shall be 445 ± 1.59 mm (17-1/2 ± 1/16 "), center to center. The distance from center of holes to top of pad shall be 12.7 ± 1.59 mm (1/2 ± 1/16 "). A metal or plastic clamp strip or hinged bar shall firmly hold the paper pads on posts or projections. The strip or bar shall be the full width of the working surface of the panel and shall be provided with a locking device.

3. Storage Container. A storage container which shall store a 12.7 x 5.1 x 3.2 cm (5 x 2 x 1-1/4 ") felt eraser along with at least six crayons, or felt tip markers, or pieces of chalk, or a combination of all three shall be either permanently attached to the back of the panel or an integral part of the chalk trough or shelf (see 2.B.5.).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. Leg Assembly. The easel shall be of either three-leg or four-leg construction at the manufacturer's option, provided that necessary support is assured for maximum stability. Each leg shall be made of tubing or channel (see 2.D.2.) with a wall thickness of not less than 1.24 mm (0.049"). The hinges, braces, and springs, if used, shall be a suitable metal (see 2.D.2.) and shall be riveted, welded, or otherwise secured in such a manner as to permit the legs to fold or telescope into the back of the panel and to facilitate assembly of the easel. A clip or similar device shall hold the legs in a closed position for easy and safe storage and transportation. The bottom of each leg shall be designed to protect floors and prevent the easel from moving when in use.

5. Chalk Trough or Shelf. The easel shall contain a front mounted trough or shelf for holding writing instruments. The trough or shelf shall be not less than 45.7 cm (18") long, 6.4 cm (2-1/2") wide, 2.5 cm (1") deep, and shall be made from material of sufficient thickness to firmly support the chalk, eraser, crayons, and when applicable, paperboard or other matter. The trough or shelf shall be so constructed that it will correctly align and securely fasten at each of the levels. The chalk trough or shelf may have an integral drawer for storage of eraser, crayons, and chalk (see 2.B.3.).

C. Dimensions. The easel shall stand not less then 178 cm (70") high when unfolded and in the upright position. When folded for handling and storage, the dimensions of the easel shall be a maximum of 7.6 cm (3") deep, 74 cm (29-1/8") wide, and 101.9 cm (40-1/8") high.

D. Materials.

1. Panel. If hardboard is used, it shall be 3.18 ± 0.25 mm (0.125 ± 0.010 ") thick with front chalkboard service. If aluminum or steel is used, the thickness of the material shall be 1.98 ± 0.38 mm (0.078 ± 0.015 "). If suitable metal is substituted, the thickness of the material shall be 1.98 ± 0.40 mm (5/64 ± 1/64 ").

2. Leg assembly and components. Steel used in the fabrication of parts and subassemblies for the construction of the easel, shall be of extruded steel of a commercial quality capable of meeting all the requirements of this document. Aluminum used in the fabrication of parts and subassemblies for the construction of the easel shall be extruded aluminum alloy of a commercial quality capable of meeting the requirements of this specification. All metal used in the construction of the easel shall be corrosion resistant or covered with corrosion resistant additives, in accordance with normal commercial practice.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

E. Operating Instructions. Operating instructions for the opening and folding of the easel shall be prominently displayed and securely attached to the back of the panel.

F. Identification Marking. Each easel shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark.

G. Workmanship. Rivets, if used, shall be set in accordance with normal commercial practice, including but not limited to exhibiting a well formed, firm, flush seating. All other fasteners shall be firmly tightened. The easel shall be rigid, stable and sturdy during its normal service. All the parts shall be properly aligned. The easel shall not fluctuate or vibrate in any way when pressure from the writing hand is applied to its writing surface. All the materials used, shall be of good commercial quality. The easel shall be free from burrs, rough or sharp edges, scratches, discoloration, or other defects or imperfections which will impair serviceability and adversely affect appearance or which might constitute a personal hazard to the user.

3. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS:

A. Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B. Contractor Certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices.

C. Sampling. Samples shall be selected for inspection in accordance with MIL-STD-105. A lot shall consist of a number of sample units manufactured by the same process from the same components at the same time. Random samples shall be drawn from each lot for the end item inspection. The sample unit shall be one easel. The design, construction, dimensions, materials, performance and workmanship shall have an inspection level of S-3 and the AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

D. Performance Test. Samples shall be set up in accordance with manufacturer's instructions. Any parts missing or failure of components to assemble properly shall constitute a failure. Samples shall be placed on an uncarpeted floor and tested as follows:

Using a black dry erase marker, write ten (10) letters (B, D, E, H, K, Q, R, V, W, X) 5 cm (2") high. The writing shall be clearly visible from a twenty 6.1 meters (20') distance. The letters shall be erasable with a clean, felt eraser. During the performance of this test, the easel shall remain in a functional, secure, standing position.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS: The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance Paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation.

5. PACKAGING, PACKING, MARKING AND PALLETIZATION: Shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

6. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS: The issue of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

A. Federal Regulations.

Federal Acquisition Regulation. Paragraph 23.403

Copies of the U.S. Code may be obtained through the Congressional Sales Office, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington D.C. 20402.

B. Military Standard.

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Available from: Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094, or as directed by the contracting officer.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7. ORDERING DATA: Purchasers shall specify the following in the contract or purchase order.

(a). Title, number, and date of this Commercial Item Description
(b). Type of easel required.
(c). Unit of issue and quantity
(d). Packaging, packing, marking and palletization requirements.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T08:26Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.